



2-09-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qzGVvIT_H_E
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Education Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education was called to order by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill (President), Mr. Heater, Mrs. Spaales, Mr. Irwin, and other board members. (Note: Presiding officer noted roll call at [02:08](#)).
 - **Absent:** Members not explicitly noted as absent during roll call.
 - **Special Guest:** Muncie Mayor Ridenour ([02:23](#)).

3. Procedural & Preliminary Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance ([01:25](#)).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were not explicitly voted on during this specific segment, though standard consent agenda items (A through G) were approved via voice vote later in the meeting ([10:54](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Presentation: Mayor Ridenour's Address

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:02:23 Special Guest Presentation by Mayor Ridenour
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Ridenour
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mayor Ridenour congratulated the board, administration, teachers, and students regarding recent positive academic and community statistics. Specifically, he highlighted 10th-grade state math test results showing Muncie Community Schools outperforming several districts in cities of similar size (including Indianapolis Public Schools, Gary, Kokomo, Richmond, Anderson, Elkhart, South Bend, and Lafayette).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote taken.

Presentation: Muncie Southside Middle School Robotics Team

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:07:24 VEX IQ Robotics State Qualification Presentation
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brian Derome (Teacher) alongside students Lee Russell and Nicole South.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome introduced the robotics program at Southside Middle School, funded partly by a Ball Brothers Foundation grant and Ball State University partnership. Students explained their robot design and competition mechanics. The team won the Jay County league event and qualified for the VEX IQ state championships, marking a first for Muncie schools.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote taken.

Presentation: School Resource Officer (SRO) Uniform Unveiling

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:19:16 SRO Uniform Modernization & Presentation
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Dudley, introducing SROs Mark Canan and Dawson Sloan.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Dudley presented a shift in SRO uniforms away from traditional stark black-and-white police attire to softer-colored pull-overs and relaxed garments (retaining concealed badges and sidearms). The goal is to project a more approachable, supportive image to students to foster positive relationships.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote taken.

Presentation: Muncie Area Career Center (MAC) Update

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:24:17 Muncie Area Career Center Annual Report & Highlights
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Beasley (MAC Principal)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Beasley shared updates on Career and Technical Education (CTE) programs, noting an enrollment increase to 360 students despite pandemic challenges. He highlighted student dual credits, industry certifications, and the construction classes' successful project building a home for a local Vietnam veteran (John Holliday) in partnership with community organizations.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote taken.

Presentation: MCS Preschool Program Update

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:42:27 Preschool Expansion & "On My Way Pre-K" Report
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Price
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Price reported on the expansion of preschool classrooms into elementary buildings, noting full capacity at several sites and ongoing efforts to achieve Level 3 and Level 4 "Path to Quality" ratings. Discussion included hiring instructional assistants, utilization of the *Fountas & Pinnell* reading curriculum, and tracking longitudinal kindergarten readiness.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote taken.

Superintendent's Report & COVID-19 Guidelines Update

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:58:02 Superintendent COVID-19 Guidance & District Updates
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. K (Superintendent)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. K reviewed updated Indiana Department of Health (IDOH) guidelines, including revised contact tracing rules allowing 3-foot distancing with masks in classrooms, Abbott BinaxNOW antigen testing protocols, and modified quarantine timelines. Additional district highlights included Central's color guard making state finals, Deb Houston receiving the Muncie citizenship award, and elementary reading program recognitions.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no board vote taken.

Consent Agenda (Items A through G)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 01:02:58 Consent Agenda Items A<U+2013>G (Including Donations, Retirements, and Financial Dispositions)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed routine consent items, including community donations (notably contributions toward a new school mascot costume) and staff retirements.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (01:05:41).

Support Staff Evaluation Tool

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:05:51](#) Approval of Revised Support Staff Evaluation Tool
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / HR
- **Deliberation Summary:** Administration presented an updated support staff evaluation tool replacing a 1991 version to align evaluation language with certified staff ("highly effective" / "effective") and shift evaluation frequency from every three years to every two years.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([01:08:31](#)).

Student and Family Handbook Approval

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:08:47](#) 2021-2022 Student and Family Handbook and Support Guide
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds presented the 2021-2022 student handbook for renewal following a comprehensive committee review. No substantive policy changes were made, only formatting, date updates, and minor grammatical corrections.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([01:10:39](#)).

Easement Grant for Recreational Trail

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:10:41](#) Easement for Recreational Trail at Muncie Central High School Levee
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered granting an easement along the Muncie Central High School levee bordering the river to the west to facilitate a multi-year crushed-gravel ADA-accessible recreational trail project.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([01:11:58](#)).

Amendment of Schmidt Associates Contract (Roof Project)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:12:03](#) Schmidt Associates Architect Contract Amendment & 2021 Roof Project
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome requested permission to amend the Schmidt Associates contract to plan and bid a 2021 roof project (~63,000 square feet across Southside Middle School and Northview Elementary; estimated cost \$668,000). Funds are leftover proceeds from the original 2014 General Obligation (GO) bond. Legal counsel confirmed leftover proceeds are appropriately bound to original bond uses.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([01:14:30](#)).

Financial Report

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:14:32](#) Monthly Financial Report (January 2021)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented January 2021 financial results, noting basic state grant receipts (~\$3.2 million monthly, ~\$39 million projected annually), a checkbook balance of over \$28.5 million, projected surplus across funds, continued state loan repayment per schedule, and a rainy-day fund balance exceeding \$9.4 million.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote ([01:16:16](#)).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open floor public comments were recorded during this portion of the transcript.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board members and administration expressed mutual appreciation for staff, students, and Mayor Ridenour's participation.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned via motion by Mr. Lowe, seconded by Mr. Heater, and approved by voice vote ([01:19:35](#)).
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